PRIMARY FIVE ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Term One | Week 3 | Lesson 2

THE PAST SIMPLE PASSIVE

Learning objectives

- Explain the meaning of the past simple passive.

- Recognise and use the correct sentence patterns.

- Write clear and correct sentences in this lesson.

Meaning

The past simple passive describes a completed past action and focuses on the person or thing receiving it.

Important rules

- Form: receiving subject + was/were + past participle.

- Use was with a singular subject and were with a plural subject.

- A by-phrase may tell us who performed the action.

Examples

1. The door was opened by Asha.

2. The desks were repaired yesterday.

3. The beans were harvested last month.

4. The gate was painted blue.

5. The room was cleaned by the pupils.

6. Were the books returned?

Worked example

Question: Make passive: The gardener watered the flowers.

Answer: The flowers were watered by the gardener.

Common mistakes

Incorrect	Correct
The plate were washed.	The plate was washed.
The chairs was broken.	The chairs were broken.
The wall was paint.	The wall was painted.
The maize was ate.	The maize was eaten.

PRACTICE EXERCISES

A. Complete the sentences or expressions.

1. The grass ___ (cut) yesterday.

_____

2. The letters ___ (post) on Monday.

_____

3. The gate ___ (lock) last night.

_____

4. The plates ___ (wash) after lunch.

_____

5. The cup ___ (break) yesterday.

_____

6. The pupils ___ (choose) for the team.

_____

B. Rewrite or correct as instructed.

7. Make passive: The gardener watered the flowers.

_____

_____

8. Make passive: The pupils cleaned the windows.

_____

_____

9. Make negative: The doors were opened.

_____

_____

10. Make a question: The food was cooked.

_____

_____

C. Find and correct the mistakes.

11. The plate were washed.

_____

12. The chairs was broken.

_____

13. The wall was paint.

_____

14. The maize was ate.

_____

D. Read and answer.

15. State one important rule from this lesson.

_____

_____

16. Write one correct example related to this lesson.

_____

_____

17. Explain the meaning of the grammar form studied.

_____

_____

E. Write your own sentences.

18. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

_____

19. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

_____

20. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

Remember

- Form: receiving subject + was/were + past participle.
- Use was with a singular subject and were with a plural subject.
- A by-phrase may tell us who performed the action.